Dear Review Committee,

I strongly support Dr. Ameek Bhalla's application for the ITI Postdoctoral Fellowship under the Translational Entrepreneurship track (inclusive of both for-profit and non-profit translational efforts). My research at the Institute for Systems Biology (ISB), the Buck Institute for Research on Aging and Phenome Health focuses extensively on the integration of complex multi-omic datasets (proteomics, metabolomics, and transcriptomics) to develop biomarkers and health measures for precision medicine.

Having previously collaborated with Dr. Bhalla, I am familiar with his strong background in data analysis, particularly his expertise in rigorous statistical modeling and data visualization. His proposed project leverages this background effectively. In my role as collaborating mentor, I will specifically train Dr. Bhalla on how to integrate proteomic, metabolomic, and transcriptomic data, utilizing approaches such as graph neural networks and factor analysis—core components of my expertise.

Given my appointments at ISB, Buck and Phenome Health—a non-profit startup dedicated to translating biomarker discoveries into practical clinical tools—I am uniquely positioned to guide Dr. Bhalla in strategically evaluating biomarkers not only for biological relevance but also for practical clinical use and scalability. I will facilitate his interaction with clinicians, entrepreneurs, and regulatory experts, providing lessons for biomarker selection and clinical implementation.

Through this collaboration, Dr. Bhalla should gain critical skills in biomarker evaluation and industry-relevant decision-making, positioning him effectively for a career in entrepreneurial and translational research.

Sincerely,

Dr. Noa Rappaport
Principal Scientist,
Institute for Systems Biology

Research Associate Professor
Buck Institute for Research on Aging

Chief Data Officer,
Phenome Health